NICHOLLS STATE UNIVERSITY

Human Subjects Institutional Review Board

IRB Briefing for Juliann Allen & Jon Murphy

Pre-meeting summary of studies proposed for review

February 24, 2026

1. Project Documents (IRB Applications)

Study	Document	Link
Conjoint Analysis	Protocol modification (add LAI)	Protocol submissions
HR SJT	Protocol & materials	Protocol submissions
Whole-Person Fit	Protocol & materials	Protocol submissions
EI × RPM	Protocol & materials	Protocol submissions
Goal Setting	Protocol & materials	Protocol submissions

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2. Studies Proposed for Review

1. Conjoint Analysis — Protocol Modification *(Exempt, already approved)*

Protocol: IRBE20251031-005CBA

PI: Dr. Martin Meder

Co-I: Dr. Christopher Castille

Status: Approved Oct 31, 2025

Request: Add the Loss Aversion Inventory (LAI) to the existing protocol.

Change: Minimal — one additional measure; no change to core procedures or risk level.

LAI link: https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/platform/assessment-flow.html?assessment=lai

2. Emotional Intelligence & Fluid Intelligence Study — New study

Purpose: Test whether fluid EI is distinct from crystallized IQ

Participants: Undergrads (psychology/business), 18+

Duration: 30–40 minutes

Procedures: Self-estimates → video-based EI assessment → Raven's Progressive Matrices → immediate feedback (percentiles, bias visualization, radar charts).

Note: Feedback reports will be provided for review before approval.

3. HR Situational Judgment Test — Pending

Purpose: Compare student vs. HR professional ratings of HR tactics across 27 scenarios

Participants: MNGT 425 students + HR professionals (recruited via networks)

Duration: 45–60 minutes

Review type: Exempt (Category D)

Suggested reviewers: Jon Murphy (CBA), Juliann Allen

4. Whole-Person Fit Assessment — Pending

Purpose: Compare interests, values, skills, personality to 867 O*NET occupations

Participants: Nicholls undergrads (PRAMS recruitment)

Duration: 15–20 minutes

Review type: Exempt (Category D)

Suggested reviewers: Jon Murphy (CBA), Juliann Allen

5. Goal Setting (A Study in Decision Making) — Approved *(Approved July 2024)*

Protocol: IRB 2024-07-30-001 CBA

PI: Dr. Christopher Castille

Purpose: Replication of Schweitzer et al. (2004) — goal setting and unethical behavior

Participants: Undergrads (18+); ARIM-sponsored

Duration: ~1 hour

Mode: Lab

Suggested reviewers: Jon Murphy (CBA), Juliann Allen

3. Issues to Be Aware Of

Study	Issue
All	Minimal risk; anonymized data (PRAMS IDs only); electronic consent
HR SJT	HR professionals enter first/last name for ID generation; names not stored with research data
EI × RPM	Feedback includes Dunning–Kruger–style bias comparison; debrief materials available for review
Whole-Person Fit	Standard career-assessment feedback
Goal Setting	Lab study; anagram tasks; optional cash reward (up to $14) per approved protocol

4. Access

- **Admin:** Admin panel
- **Researcher dashboard:** Study list

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5. Full IRB Documents (for review)

- **Protocol submissions:** View all submissions
- **IRB member dashboard:** IRB dashboard
- **Researcher dashboard:** Study list

6. Federal Audit Compliance (No Credit/Bonus)

> **Context:** SONA/PRAMS is live but shadow IT. We will not use course credit or monitor bonus points. What is required to survive a federal audit?
>
> **Why no credit/bonus changes FERPA:** Without credit/bonus, participation is voluntary research—not used for grading. Per Cornell IRB and case law (Owasso v. Falvo, Hardin County Schools v. Foster), voluntary research data not used for institutional decisions is not FERPA-protected education records.

Minimum Requirements

45 CFR 46 (Common Rule):

- IRB oversight for all studies
- Informed consent documented
- Risk minimization; data security (TLS, access controls)

FERPA:

- Greatly reduced without credit/bonus
- Keep research data anonymous or de-identified
- No link between participation and grades

Data Security:

- TLS/HTTPS
- Role-based access
- Audit logging for protocol submissions, IRB decisions, exports

Audit Trail:

- Who submitted, when, decision
- Who approved, when
- Log data exports; log AI API calls (hash only)

Data Retention:

- Document policy (e.g., 5 years post-study)
- Purge or anonymize when no longer needed

Disable Without Credit

- CreditTransaction — disable
- Bonus-point tracking — disable
- Student ID for research participants — don't collect

Formalization Options

Option	Cost	Audit Posture
Keep as shadow IT	$0	Higher risk
Localize/formalize	Dev time	Better: documented controls
Purchase SONA (~$2K)	$2K	Best: vendor-assessed

Recommended Minimum

1. Disable credit allocation and bonus-point features
2. Use anonymous participation (session_id, no participant FK)
3. Document that participation is voluntary and not used for grades
4. Maintain IRB approval for all studies
5. Add audit logging for protocol submissions, IRB decisions, exports
6. Restrict self-registration to participant role only
7. Retain consent records and protocol documentation per IRB

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Pre-meeting briefing for IRB reviewers. PRAMS: bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/

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